



Delaware County Council Meeting July 27th 2021

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LCATpUMAU94
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Delaware County Council Meeting Report

Meeting Date: July 27, 2021

Meeting Time: 9:00 AM

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding Officer Scott Alexander called the Delaware County Council regular meeting to order at 9:00 AM on July 27, 2021, and led attendees in the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Mr. Ballard, Ms. Chambers, Ms. Lasseter, Ms. Piper, Mr. Quakenbush, Mr. Webb, and Mr. Alexander.
 - **Absent:** None noted.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Scott Alexander.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Opening prayer/invocation (implied/spoken by Steve) and the Pledge of Allegiance.

- **Approval of Agenda:** The agenda was advertised, posted, and approved via roll call vote (Passed Unanimously).
 - **Public Contact Notice:** Presiding Officer Alexander reminded citizens that questions can be directed to county council via email at council.dist@co.delaware.in.us or by contacting individual council members.
 - **Approval of Prior Minutes:** The June meeting minutes were approved via roll call vote (Passed Unanimously).
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

00:02:54 Ordinance 2021-016: Second Reading <U+2013> Economic Development Revenue Bonds (Can Pack Project)

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Tracy Lutton (Muncie Delaware County Economic Development Alliance), alongside company representatives including plant manager Dusty Jordan and bond counsel.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Lutton presented the second reading for the Can Pack project bonds, noting no prior questions had been raised. An amendment was introduced to reflect that negotiations have progressed such that bonds will be issued on a tax-exempt basis rather than a taxable basis (altering the final version distributed the previous afternoon).
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** Dusty Jordan, plant manager for Can Pack, thanked the council for their support.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:**
 - Motion to adopt: Approved.
 - Motion to amend with new language: Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously).
 - Motion to approve amended second reading: Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously).

00:08:31 Transfer & Finance Requests

EMS Staffing Transfer

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioners / EMS Department.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Adjustments among paramedic and advanced EMT lines resulting in a total request of zero net change.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously).

Title IV-D Court Insurance & Uniforms Transfer

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jill (Court Department).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer involving insurance and uniform/robe lines. The request was adjusted down from \$2,000 to \$1,000 to cover specific deputy uniform items, a master commissioner's robe (\$227), and embroidery costs.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to reduce to \$1,000 approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously); motion to approve as amended passed by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously).

Sheriff's Office / Corrections Staffing Transfers

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Nancy Marvin (Delaware County Sheriff's Office).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Reallocations among correction officer lines. Marvin provided an update on the hiring pipeline, noting ongoing recruitment efforts, a 24-to-36-hour turnaround for drug tests, and upcoming hires for August and September.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously).

Additional Correctional Officer Line Transfer

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Nancy Marvin (Sheriff's Office) / Jill.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of funds (\$16,585.02) within correctional officer lines; subsequent lines withdrawn.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously).

Family Recovery Court Grant Transfer (Case Manager)

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Ashley Soldat (COST Director).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Grant fund transfers matching VOCA to accommodate a staff transfer to the juvenile court and backfilling the position.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously).

VOCA Grant Transfers

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Ashley Soldat (COST Director).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Reallocation of grant matching funds following internal staffing shifts and rehiring of a staff member affected during COVID-19.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously).

EMS Transfer Addendum

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** EMS Department.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Budget line adjustments resulting in a zero net request.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously).

911 Communications Transfer

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Paul Singleton (Director of 911).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Transfers totaling zero net change. Director Singleton provided a staffing update, noting 5 trainees, 4 current floor vacancies plus 5 pending hires, leaving a shortage of 9 fully released dispatchers. Singleton also noted the application, typing test, multi-tasking pre-test, background check, and advertising practices (including Indeed and Facebook). Council inquired about delayed state funding revenue.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously).

Juvenile Home / Financial Agenda Transfers

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Juvenile Home administration / Financial team.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Requests included part-time staffing, institutional care, and CARES Act reimbursement (\$215,555 down to specific itemized COVID-19 safety and sanitizing expenses). Council member Ryan Webb moved to reduce the part-time line request from \$60,000 to \$30,000 to closely monitor spending.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to reduce part-time portion to \$30,000 approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously). Motion to approve financial agenda as amended passed by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously).

Coroner's Office: Autopsy Labs and X-Rays

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Coroner's Office representative.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Request for \$80,000 to cover mounting autopsy costs (\$1,200 standard autopsy fee plus toxicology and x-rays). The office noted a significant rise in cases over recent years (e.g., 257 autopsies last year, tracking near 160 currently) driven by suicides, overdoses, homicides, car fatalities, and unexpected deaths.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously).

EMA: COVID-19 Supplies

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** John Cuttino (Director of Emergency Management).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Reappropriation of \$10,290.35 in grant funds (originally from Ball Brothers and first responders) to continue purchasing PPE for the county stockpile.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously).

Jail Overtime, Inmate Meals, Uniforms, and Schooling

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jail Administration / Sheriff's Office.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Request for \$139,000 to reimburse accounts utilized in July for inmate meals, uniforms, schooling, and overtime, as well as covering ongoing operational

costs through the end of the year.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously).

Family Recovery Court: Program Coordinator Payout

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Emily Anderson (Court Administrator).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriate \$728.15 from grant funds to cover vacation payout for a departing program coordinator.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously).
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **01:06:59 Andrew Pop (Muncie Resident):** Expressed appreciation for the council's accessibility and discussions regarding the sheriff's department, jail, and 911 center. Inquired about the schedule for upcoming budget hearings and emphasized prioritizing funding for public safety officers who work irregular hours and holidays under high-stress conditions.
 - **01:07:17 (Council & Public Exchange):** Council members discussed distinctions between 911 dispatch staffing/leadership and the sheriff's department. Council member Ryan Webb noted his recent experience working a partial shift at the jail and highlighted staffing pressures (e.g., correctional officers unable to secure leave for weddings).
 - **01:01:17 Troy (Muncie Resident):** Voiced strong support for the Delaware County Sheriff's Department, noting retention struggles shared with the city police department. Encouraged the council and commissioners to use American Rescue Plan (ARP) funds creatively to free up resources for deputy raises.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff & Board Announcements:**
 - **Sheriff Tony Skinner** distributed informational packets covering jail meal costs (averaging \$1.36 per meal), booking/release statistics, a six-month pension update noting the pension fund balance crested \$20 million (approx. \$20,185,768), an Adams County jail pay/staffing study, and local pay study snapshots. Skinner clarified that the county council has met with him collaboratively and urged council members to tour or work a shift in the jail prior to the September budget hearings.
 - **Charlie Walker Recognition:** Council members and staff thanked Charlie Walker for his years of county service ahead of his departure next Friday, announcing a going-away party on the plaza from 11:00 AM to 1:00 PM.
 - **Special Budget Work Session:** Scheduled for **Thursday, August 12, at 1:00 PM** to review updated financial figures and state revenue information prior to formal

budget hearings.

- **Actuarial Review:** Council member Ron expressed concern regarding the long-term solvency of the sheriff's pension plan given potential salary increases, noting discussions with Baker Tilly regarding an actuarial scope of work.
- **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially adjourned following a motion by Mr. Ballard, seconded by Ms. Piper, and approved by unanimous roll call vote.

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